

Q.7b (15 marks): Culture is unique to human beings - arguments in favour and against

(Don't Write anything in this A)

b) Culture is unique to human beings. Do you agree? Present arguments in favour and against the statement. (15 marks)

EB Tylor in his book 'Primitive Culture (1871)' defines culture as 'a complex whole, that includes knowledge, belief, art, Morals, law, customs and all other capabilities acquired by man as member of society.'

→ Other scholars like B. Malinowski and M. Hertz also use 'man' to define culture advocating that it is unique to human beings.

Arguments ~~in favour~~ against :

→ Studies by Culture Primatologist WC McGrew (1998) advocate that Culture is ^{not} unique to human beings. Following aspects are considered :

- (Don't Write anything in this margin)
- ① Several primates and their practices show elements of culture.
 - ② Learned behaviour, transparency, Ideational, Dynamism is found in the practices of several primates.

Examples to oppose

- ① 'Feral Man' or the man who was raised by wolves show elements of wild. (learned behaviour).
- ② Jane Goodall (1986) study on gestural communication of chimpanzees.
- ③ Penny Patterson study on Koko gorilla.

Arguments: Unique to human beings

↳ Views of Leslie White He opines that the ability to have culture is deeply connected with ability to use language.
- Examples of this use is simply an

imitation and next use of language:

- Use involves giving arbitrary meanings to words and comprehending these words which only humans can do.

↳ Views of Michael Tomasello

- Culture needs an ability to collect cognitive meanings and resources to give and change meanings. Such ability is only found in human beings.

→ The ability to use tools, or imitate symbols is observed in experiments but do not conform to the requirements above. So, as of now culture looks like an aspect which is unique to human beings.

Marks:

Comment:

Intro:

Body:

Conclusion:

Total: